Class 7 Social Science – Chapter 1

Geographical Diversity of India

NCERT | Exploring Society: India and Beyond | Simple English Question–Answers

इस अध्याय के PDF के आधार पर नीचे सभी मुख्य विषयों के सरल अंग्रेजी में प्रश्न-उत्तर, पाठ के अंत में दिए गए सभी 9 प्रश्नों के उत्तर तथा परीक्षा के लिए महत्वपूर्ण अतिरिक्त प्रश्न-उत्तर दिए गए हैं। उत्तर कक्षा 7 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार आसान अंग्रेजी में रखे गए हैं।

1. Chapter overview

India has many different geographical features. It has high mountains, fertile plains, deserts, plateaus, long coastlines, islands, forests and rivers. These features affect our climate, food, clothes, houses, occupations, culture and history.

The main geographical regions discussed in this chapter are:

1. The Himalayan Mountains
2. The Cold Desert of Ladakh
3. The Gangetic Plains
4. The Thar Desert
5. The Aravalli Hills
6. The Peninsular Plateau
7. The West Coast and the East Coast
8. The Indian Islands
9. The Sundarbans
10. The Hills of Northeast India

Part A: Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic 1: India and its geographical diversity

Q1. Which is the seventh-largest country in the world?

Answer: India is the seventh-largest country in the world.

Q2. In which continent is India located?

Answer: India is located in Asia.

Q3. What is the Indian Subcontinent?

Answer: India and its neighbouring countries form a region called the Indian Subcontinent. It is a part of the continent of Asia.

Q4. Name the neighbouring countries mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka and Myanmar are the neighbouring countries mentioned in the chapter.

Q5. What are the natural boundaries of India?

Answer: The Himalayas lie in the north, the Thar Desert and the Arabian Sea mark the western side, the Indian Ocean lies to the south, and the Bay of Bengal lies to the east.

Q6. What are the five broad geographical regions mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: They are the great mountain zone, the plains of the Ganga and the Indus, the desert region, the southern peninsula and the islands.

Q7. How does geography affect our lives?

Answer: Geography affects our climate, food, clothes, houses, occupations, transport and culture.

Q8. Why is India called a land of geographical diversity?

Answer: India has mountains, plains, deserts, plateaus, rivers, forests, coastlines and islands. Therefore, it has great geographical diversity.

Q9. What did Rakesh Sharma say when asked how India looked from space?

Answer: He replied, “Saare jahan se achchha,” which means “better than the whole world.”

Topic 2: The Himalayas







9

Q1. What are the Himalayas?

Answer: The Himalayas are a great mountain range in the north of India.

Q2. What is the approximate length of the Himalayan range?

Answer: The Himalayan range is about 2,500 kilometres long.

Q3. What are the Eight Thousanders?

Answer: Himalayan peaks that are more than 8,000 metres high are called the Eight Thousanders.

Q4. Name the three main ranges of the Himalayas.

Answer: They are the Himadri, the Himachal and the Shivalik Hills.

Q5. What is the Himadri?

Answer: The Himadri, or Greater Himalayas, is the highest and most rugged Himalayan range. Its peaks remain covered with snow throughout the year.

Q6. What is the Himachal?

Answer: The Himachal, or Lower Himalayas, lies south of the Himadri. It has a moderate climate, forests and many human settlements.

Q7. What are the Shivalik Hills?

Answer: The Shivalik Hills are the outermost and lowest range of the Himalayas. They have rolling hills and dense forests.

Q8. Name four hill stations in the Himalayan region mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Nainital, Darjeeling, Shimla and Mussoorie.

Q9. Why are the Himalayas called the ‘Water Tower of Asia’?

Answer: Snow melts in the Himalayas during summer and feeds major rivers like the Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra. These rivers provide water to millions of people. Therefore, the Himalayas are called the Water Tower of Asia.

Q10. How are the Himalayas important to people?

Answer: They provide water, support wildlife, attract tourists and are important for farming, culture and religious activities.

Q11. How were the Himalayas formed?

Answer: The Indian landmass moved northwards and collided with Eurasia about 50 million years ago. The land between them was pushed upwards and formed the Himalayas.

Q12. Are the Himalayas still growing?

Answer: Yes. The Indian landmass is still moving towards Asia, so the Himalayas continue to rise slowly.

Q13. What does the word ‘Himalaya’ mean?

Answer: The word Himalaya comes from two Sanskrit words: hima, meaning snow, and alaya, meaning abode. It means “abode of snow”.

Q14. Where does the Bhagirathi River originate?

Answer: The Bhagirathi River originates from Gaumukh, at the Gangotri Glacier in Uttarakhand.

Q15. What is a glacier?

Answer: A glacier is a large mass of ice that moves slowly over land.

Q16. What is special about kath-kuni or dhajji-dewari houses?

Answer: These traditional houses in the western Himalayas use local stone and wood. They help keep houses warm and can resist damage from mild earthquakes.

Q17. Why is the Great Himalayan National Park important?

Answer: It protects a rich variety of plants and animals. It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site, and the government and local communities help conserve its biodiversity.

Topic 3: The Cold Desert of India – Ladakh







7

Q1. What is a cold desert?

Answer: A cold desert is a dry region where temperatures can become extremely low.

Q2. Which Indian region is known as a cold desert?

Answer: Ladakh is known as a cold desert.

Q3. What is the climate of Ladakh like?

Answer: Ladakh has very little rainfall, cold winters and a rugged landscape. Winter temperatures can fall below –30°C.

Q4. Why is Ladakh called ‘Moonland’?

Answer: Ladakh has unusual rocky landforms that resemble the surface of the Moon. Therefore, it is called Moonland.

Q5. Name a famous lake in Ladakh.

Answer: Pangong Tso is a famous lake in Ladakh. Its water is salty.

Q6. Why is the water of Pangong Tso salty?

Answer: Minerals from the surrounding mountains dissolve in the lake water and make it salty.

Q7. Name three animals found in Ladakh.

Answer: The snow leopard, ibex and Tibetan antelope.

Q8. Why are yaks important to people in the Himalayas?

Answer: Yaks provide milk, meat, wool and dung. They are also used for transport.

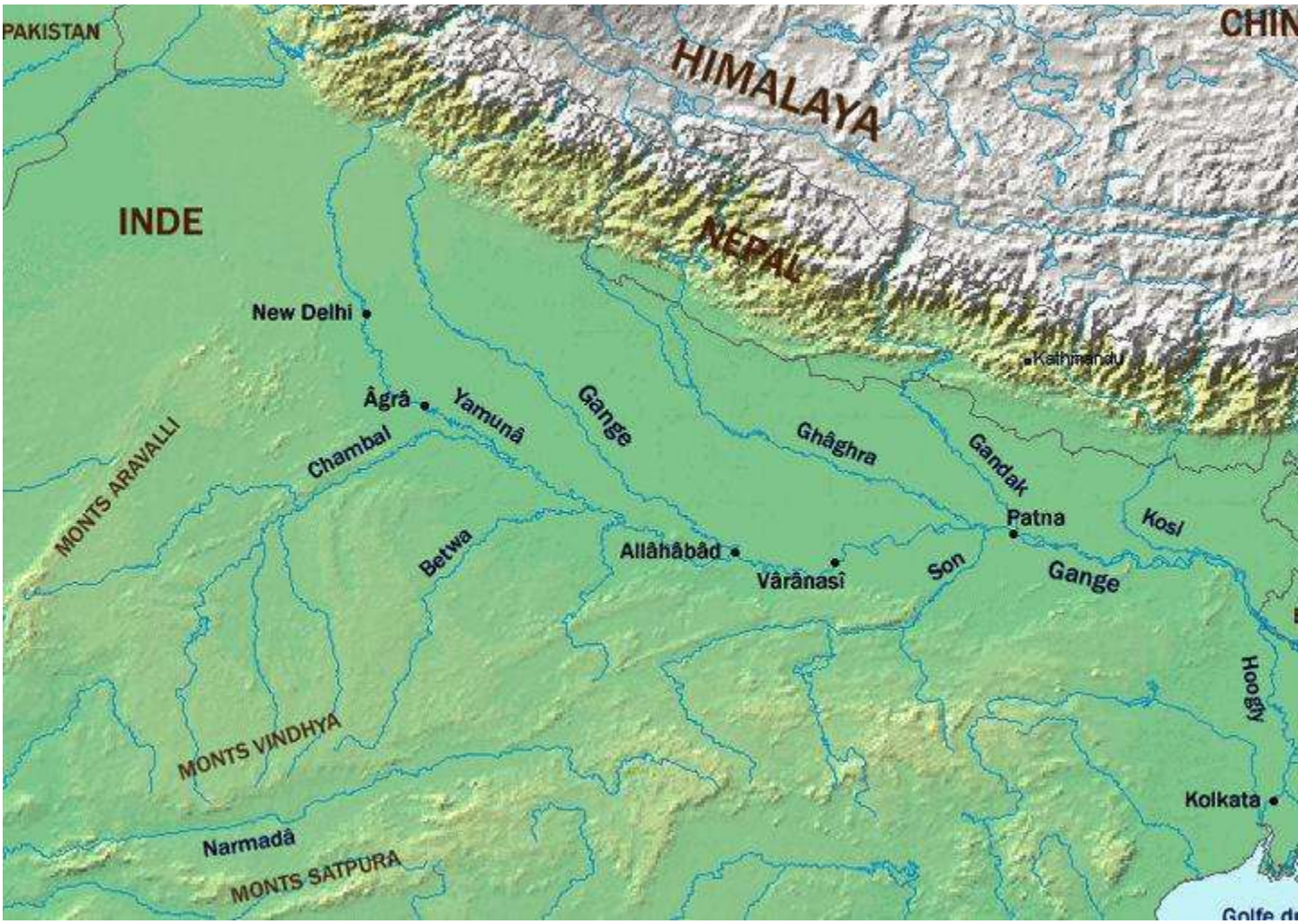
Q9. Name two festivals celebrated in Ladakh.

Answer: Losar and the Hemis Festival.

Q10. What is the main reason for the dry landscape of Ladakh?

Answer: Ladakh receives very little rainfall and has a cold, dry climate.

Topic 4: The Gangetic Plains


PAKISTAN
CHIN
HIMALAYA
INDE
NEPAL
New Delhi
Kathmandu
Âgrâ
Yamunâ
Gange
Chambal
MONTS ARAVALLI
Ghâghra
Gandak
Patna
Kosi
Betwa
Allâhâbâd
Vârânasî
Son
Gange
Hoogly
MONTS VINDHYA
Kolkata
Narmadâ
MONTS SATPURA





9

Q1. Where are the Gangetic Plains located?

Answer: The Gangetic Plains lie to the south of the Himalayas.

Q2. Why are the Gangetic Plains fertile?

Answer: Rivers bring minerals and deposit them in the soil. This makes the plains fertile and suitable for agriculture.

Q3. Name the three major river systems mentioned in this section.

Answer: The Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra river systems.

Q4. Why do many people live in the Gangetic Plains?

Answer: The plains have fertile soil, water, agricultural opportunities and good transport facilities. Therefore, many people live there.

Q5. How do rivers help farmers?

Answer: Rivers provide water for irrigation and deposit minerals that make the soil fertile.

Q6. How do rivers help in generating electricity?

Answer: Flowing or falling water can turn turbines to produce hydroelectricity.

Q7. Why is transport well developed in the Northern Plains?

Answer: The flat land makes it easier to build roads and railways. Rivers have also supported travel and trade for a long time.

Q8. What is multi-cropping?

Answer: Multi-cropping means growing more than one crop on the same piece of land in a year.

Q9. Why is the Brahmaputra River bigger during summer?

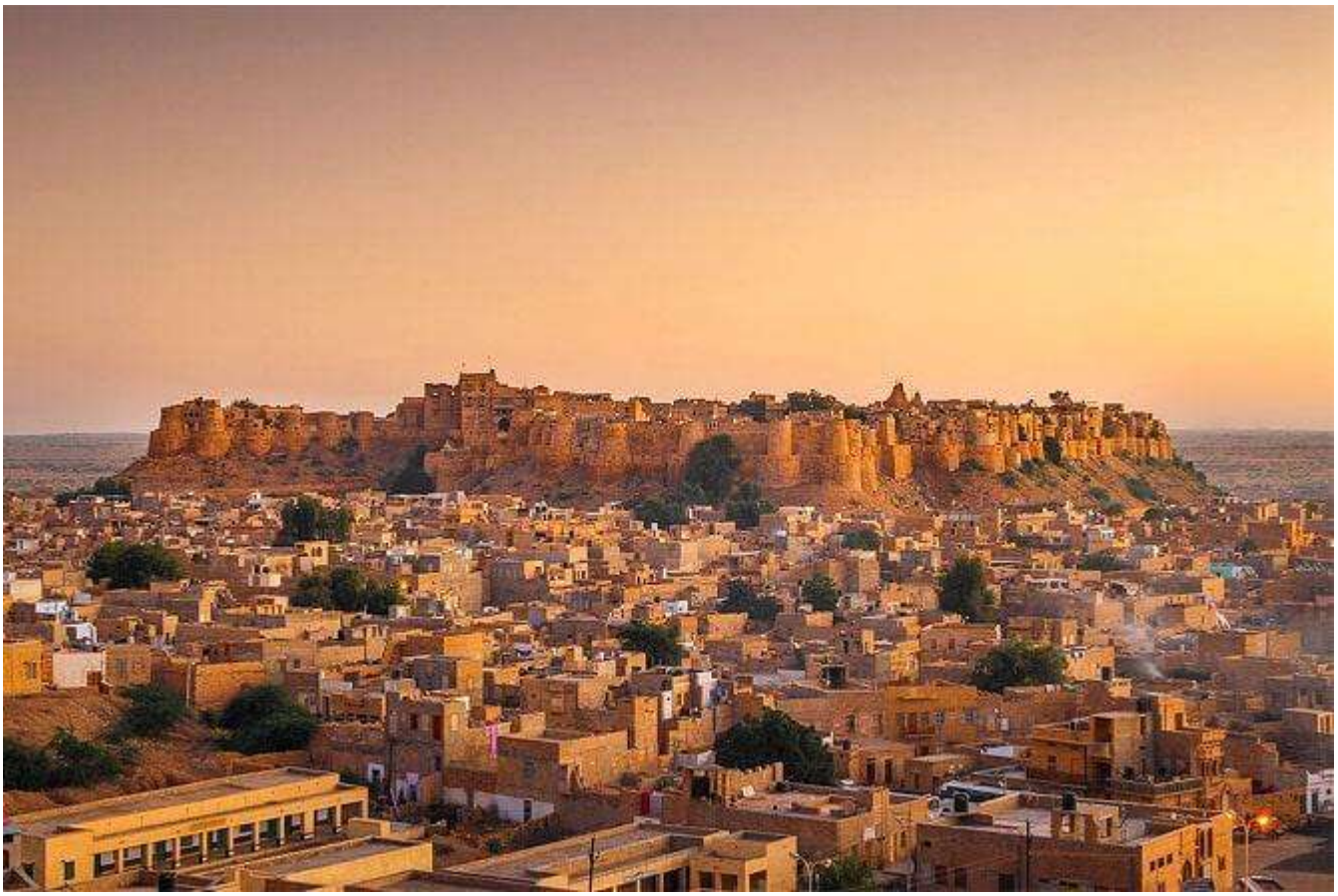
Answer: Snow melts in the Himalayas during summer, and the river also receives monsoon rainwater. This increases its volume.

Q10. Name two animals shown in the chapter that need protection.

Answer: The tiger and the Indian gharial are two animals that need protection.

Topic 5: The Great Indian Desert or Thar Desert







7

Q1. Where is the Thar Desert located?

Answer: The Thar Desert lies in the western part of India. Most of it is in India.

Q2. Name the states covered by the Thar Desert, as mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab and Haryana.

Q3. What are sand dunes?

Answer: Sand dunes are hill-like formations of sand shaped by the wind.

Q4. Why is the Thar Desert a natural barrier?

Answer: Extreme temperatures, scarce water and harsh living conditions make movement difficult for people and animals.

Q5. How have people adapted to life in the Thar Desert?

Answer: People have adapted their food habits, clothing and lifestyle to the hot days, cold nights and shortage of water.

Q6. Why is water precious in the Thar Desert?

Answer: Rainfall is low and water sources are limited. People may have to travel long distances to collect water.

Q7. What are taanka or kunds?

Answer: They are traditional water-collection systems used to store rainwater, often for drinking.

Q8. How do people save water in the Thar Desert?

Answer: They collect rainwater, reuse water when possible and avoid wasting it.

Q9. Why is Jaisalmer called the Golden City?

Answer: Jaisalmer is known as the Golden City because of its golden-coloured buildings and its location in the Thar Desert.

Q10. How are sand dunes formed?

Answer: Wind moves loose sand and deposits it in hill-like shapes, forming sand dunes.

Topic 6: The Aravalli Hills







8

Q1. Where are the Aravalli Hills located?

Answer: The Aravalli Hills are located in northwestern India.

Q2. How old are the Aravalli Hills?

Answer: The Aravalli Hills are about 2.5 billion years old.

Q3. Which is the highest peak of the Aravalli Hills mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: Mount Abu is mentioned as the highest peak of the Aravalli range.

Q4. Name the states and the region covered by the Aravalli range, as given in the chapter.

Answer: The Aravalli range extends across Delhi, Rajasthan, Haryana and Gujarat.

Q5. How do the Aravalli Hills affect the Thar Desert?

Answer: The Aravalli Hills act as a natural barrier and help prevent the Thar Desert from expanding further eastward.

Q6. Which minerals are found in the Aravalli Hills?

Answer: Marble, granite, zinc and copper are found in the Aravalli Hills.

Q7. What is special about the ancient zinc mines at Zawar?

Answer: Evidence from Zawar shows that Indians had mastered the process of extracting zinc more than eight centuries ago.

Q8. Name three historic forts located in the Aravalli region.

Answer: Chittorgarh Fort, Kumbhalgarh Fort and Ranthambore Fort.

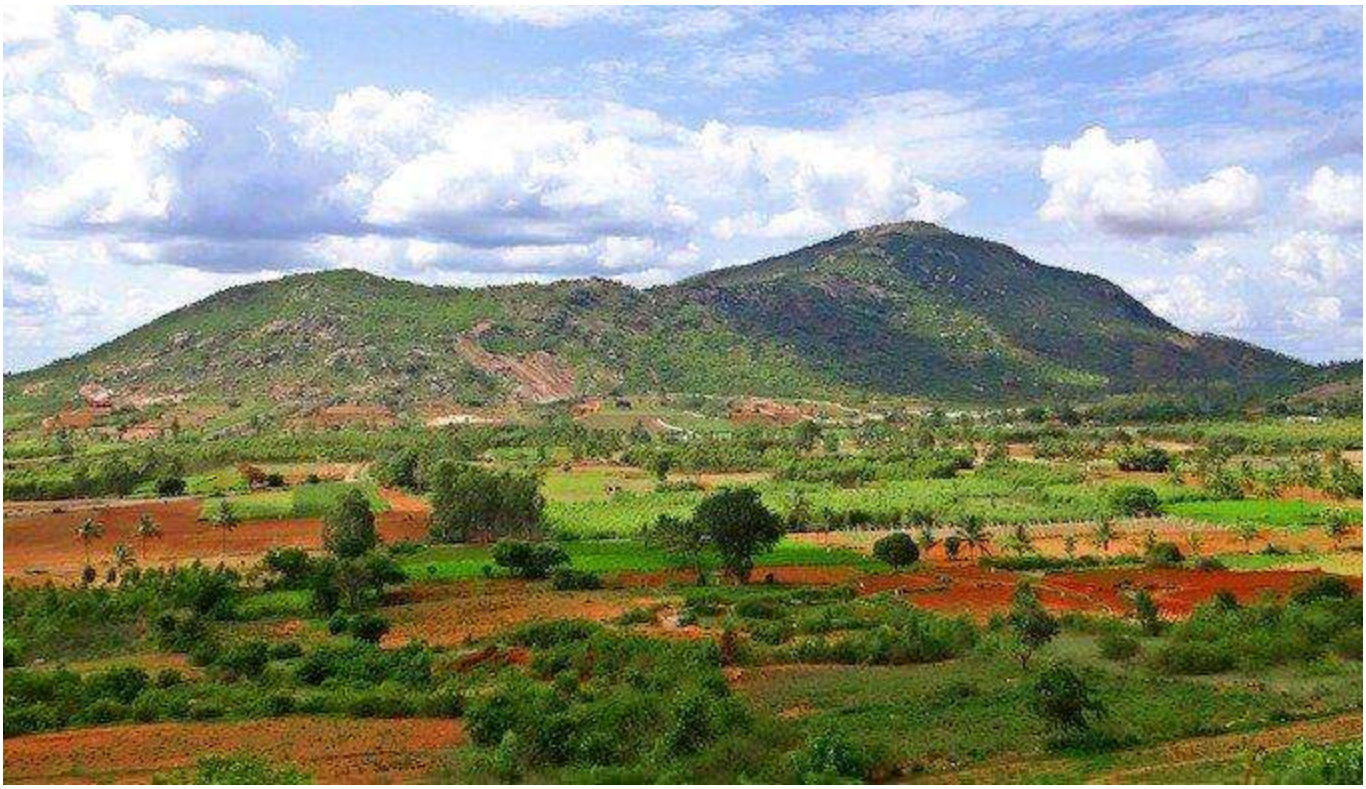
Q9. Why were forts built in the Aravalli Hills?

Answer: The hills provided natural protection and made it difficult for enemies to attack the forts.

Q10. How have the Aravalli Hills helped people?

Answer: They have provided minerals for mining and construction and have influenced the geography and climate of northwestern India.

Topic 7: The Peninsular Plateau







7

Q1. What is a plateau?

Answer: A plateau is a raised area of land with a more or less flat surface. Some of its sides have steep slopes.

Q2. What is a peninsula?

Answer: A peninsula is a piece of land surrounded by water on three sides.

Q3. Why is the southern part of India called the Peninsular Plateau?

Answer: It is a raised landmass with a mostly flat surface and is surrounded by the Arabian Sea, the Bay of Bengal and the Indian Ocean on three sides.

Q4. Name the two mountain ranges that border the Peninsular Plateau.

Answer: The Western Ghats and the Eastern Ghats.

Q5. Which range is higher, the Western Ghats or the Eastern Ghats?

Answer: The Western Ghats are higher than the Eastern Ghats.

Q6. What is the Deccan Plateau?

Answer: The Deccan Plateau is a vast area of flat highlands between the Western Ghats and the Eastern Ghats.

Q7. Name three rivers that flow from west to east across the plateau.

Answer: The Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri rivers.

Q8. Name two rivers that flow westwards into the Arabian Sea.

Answer: The Narmada and Tapti rivers.

Q9. Why is the Peninsular Plateau important for India's economy?

Answer: It is rich in minerals, forests and land resources. Its rivers provide water for farming, industries and hydroelectric power.

Q10. Why are waterfalls common on plateaus?

Answer: Rivers flow over uneven and rocky surfaces. When they descend steep slopes, waterfalls are formed.

Q11. How are waterfalls useful to people?

Answer: They attract tourists, help generate hydroelectric power and provide water for irrigation.

Q12. Name five tribal communities mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: The Santhal, Gond, Baiga, Bhil and Korku.

Q13. How are tribal communities connected with nature?

Answer: Their languages, traditions and ways of life are closely connected with forests and the natural environment.

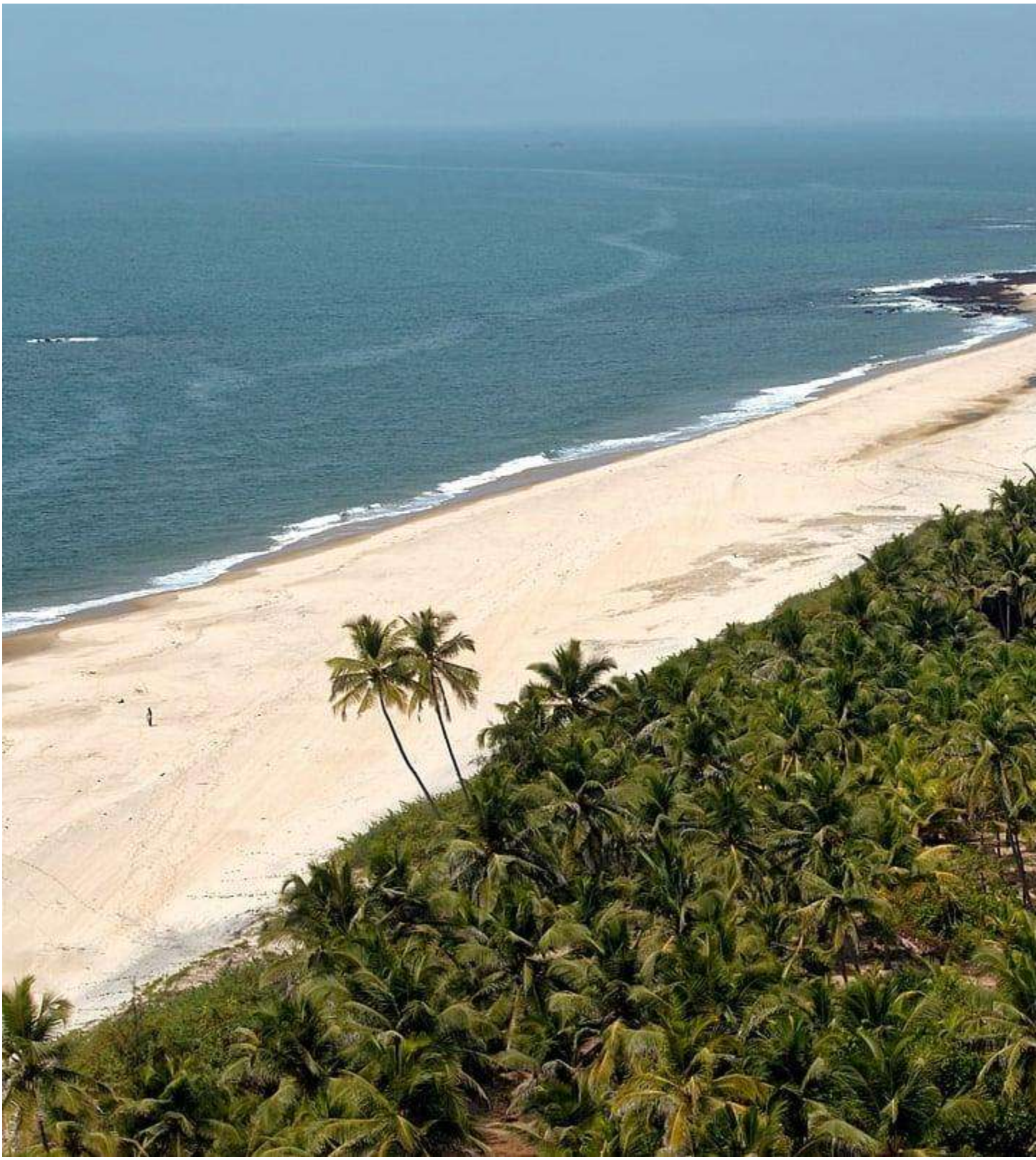
Q14. Why are the Western Ghats important?

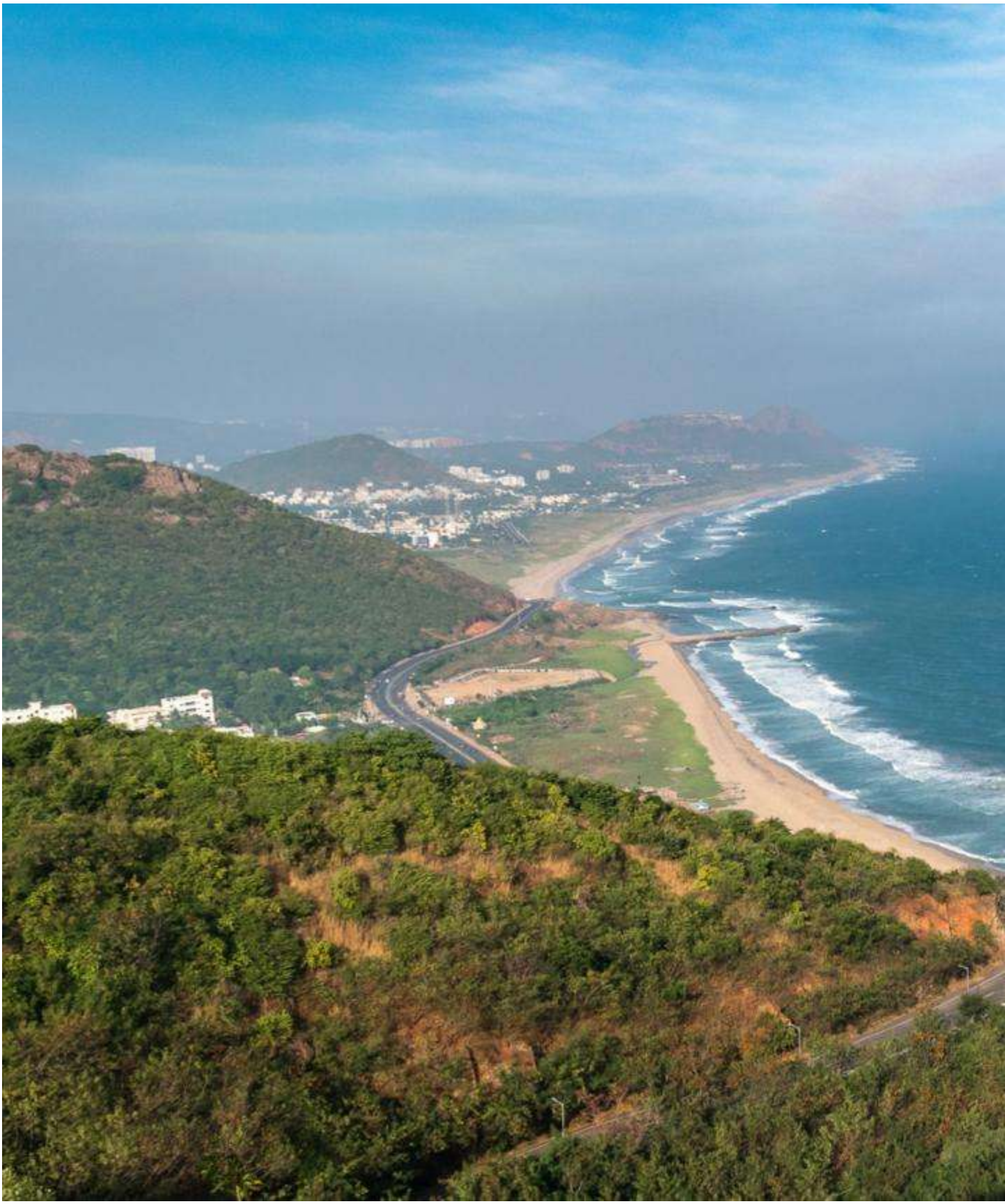
Answer: The Western Ghats have rich biodiversity, many rivers and beautiful waterfalls. They are also a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

Q15. What are the northern Western Ghats also called?

Answer: They are also called the Sahyadri Hills.

Topic 8: India's Amazing Coastlines







7

Q1. What is the approximate length of India's coastline?

Answer: India's coastline is over 7,500 kilometres long.

Q2. Which sea lies to the west of India?

Answer: The Arabian Sea lies to the west of India.

Q3. Which water body lies to the east of India?

Answer: The Bay of Bengal lies to the east of India.

Q4. Name the states along the West Coast mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka and Kerala.

Q5. Where does the West Coast of India extend from and to?

Answer: It extends from Gujarat in the north to Kerala in the south.

Q6. Why do many rivers on the West Coast flow swiftly?

Answer: Many rivers originate in the Western Ghats and flow down towards the nearby Arabian Sea. The steep slopes help them flow quickly.

Q7. What is an estuary?

Answer: An estuary is a place near the coast where a river meets the sea and its water mixes with seawater.

Q8. Name two major estuaries mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: The estuaries of the Narmada and Tapti rivers.

Q9. Where is the East Coast located?

Answer: The East Coast lies between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal.

Q10. From where to where does the East Coast extend?

Answer: It extends from the Ganga delta to Kanyakumari.

Q11. Name four major river deltas on the East Coast.

Answer: The Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri deltas.

Q12. What is a delta?

Answer: A delta is a landform formed when a river deposits sediments at its mouth. It often has a triangular or fan-like shape.

Q13. Why are river deltas fertile?

Answer: Rivers deposit sediments and nutrients in the deltas, making the soil fertile and suitable for farming.

Q14. Name two important lakes on the East Coast mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Chilika Lake and Pulicat Lake.

Q15. What is a lagoon?

Answer: A lagoon is a body of water separated from a larger body of water by a natural barrier.

Q16. Why are coastal regions important?

Answer: Coastal regions support fishing, trade, transport, ports, tourism and many economic activities.

Topic 9: The Indian Islands







7

Q1. Name India's two major island groups.

Answer: Lakshadweep and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Q2. Where are the Lakshadweep Islands located?

Answer: They are located in the Arabian Sea, close to the Malabar Coast of Kerala.

Q3. How many islands make up Lakshadweep?

Answer: Lakshadweep is made up of 36 islands.

Q4. What are coral islands?

Answer: Coral islands are islands formed mainly from the remains and structures of tiny marine animals called corals.

Q5. Where are the Andaman and Nicobar Islands located?

Answer: They are located in the Bay of Bengal.

Q6. What is an archipelago?

Answer: An archipelago is a group of islands.

Q7. Why are India's islands important?

Answer: They are important for marine resources, fishing, biodiversity, environmental protection and India's security.

Q8. What is Cellular Jail?

Answer: Cellular Jail is a historic prison in the Andaman Islands where many Indian freedom fighters were imprisoned under harsh conditions.

Q9. Why is Cellular Jail important?

Answer: It reminds us of the sacrifices made by Indian freedom fighters for the country's freedom.

Q10. Which is the only active volcano in India mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: Barren Island in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Q11. What is special about the wildlife of the Indian Islands?

Answer: The islands have unique plants and animals, beautiful beaches and rich coral reefs.

Q12. Why are the Andaman and Nicobar Islands strategically important?

Answer: Their location helps India keep watch over important sea areas and protect its maritime interests.

Topic 10: The Sundarbans







Q1. Where are the Sundarbans located?

Answer: The Sundarbans are located in the delta of the Ganga, Brahmaputra and their tributaries.

Q2. In which two countries are the Sundarbans located?

Answer: India and Bangladesh.

Q3. What are mangroves?

Answer: Mangroves are special trees and shrubs that grow in coastal areas affected by seawater and tides.

Q4. Which famous animal lives in the Sundarbans?

Answer: The Royal Bengal Tiger lives in the Sundarbans.

Q5. Why are the Sundarbans important?

Answer: They support unique wildlife and mangrove forests and form an important natural ecosystem.

Q6. What makes the Sundarbans a special geographical region?

Answer: They combine river, sea and land environments in a large delta.

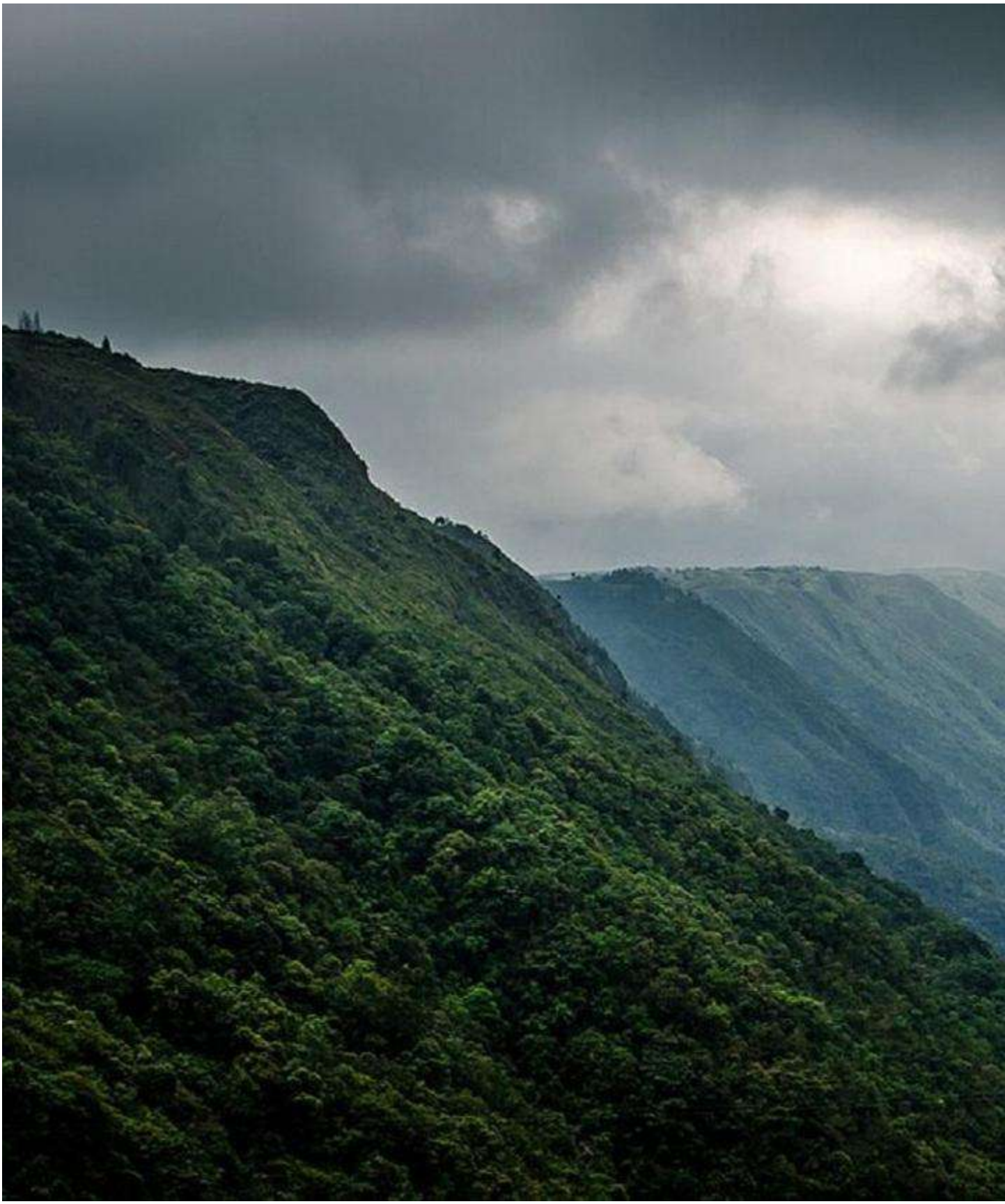
Q7. What is the heritage status of the Sundarbans mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The Sundarbans are a UNESCO Heritage Site.

Topic 11: The Hills of Northeast India







Q1. Name the three hill regions mentioned in this section.

Answer: The Garo Hills, Khasi Hills and Jaintia Hills.

Q2. In which state are these hills located?

Answer: They are located in Meghalaya.

Q3. What are these hills a part of?

Answer: They are part of the Meghalaya Plateau.

Q4. What is the climate of this region like?

Answer: The region receives heavy rainfall and has lush green forests and many waterfalls.

Q5. Why is Northeast India rich in forests and wildlife?

Answer: Heavy rainfall, fertile land and favourable natural conditions support forests and wildlife.

Q6. What are living root bridges?

Answer: Living root bridges are bridges made by guiding and weaving the roots of trees over many years.

Q7. What is Mawlynnong famous for?

Answer: Mawlynnong in Meghalaya is known for its cleanliness, eco-friendly practices and living root bridges.

Q8. How do living root bridges show the relationship between people and nature?

Answer: People guide the natural growth of tree roots to make useful bridges. This shows how people can use nature carefully and creatively.

Part B: All Textbook Questions and Activities

The following are answers to all nine questions on pages 24–25 of the uploaded NCERT chapter.

Q1. What are two important geographical features of India? Why are they important?

Answer: Two important geographical features of India are the Himalayas and the Gangetic Plains.

The Himalayas provide water to major rivers and support wildlife and tourism. The Gangetic Plains have fertile soil and plenty of water, making them suitable for agriculture and human settlements.

Q2. What might India have looked like if the Himalayas did not exist?

Answer: If the Himalayas did not exist, India would have a very different climate and landscape. The rivers fed by Himalayan snow would be different. The northern part of India might receive less protection from cold winds. The fertile plains and the history of India might also have been different.

Q3. Why is India called a ‘mini-continent’?

Answer: India is called a mini-continent because it has many different landforms and climates. It has high mountains, fertile plains, deserts, plateaus, forests, rivers, coastlines and islands. People in different regions also have different food habits, clothes, languages and cultures.

Q4. Follow one of India's big rivers from its source to the ocean. How do people use this river?

Answer: The Ganga originates from the Gangotri Glacier region, with the Bhagirathi beginning at Gaumukh in Uttarakhand. The river flows through the plains and finally reaches the Bay of Bengal through its delta.

People use the Ganga for drinking water, irrigation, farming, religious activities, transport in some stretches and other economic activities. Its water and fertile sediments support many communities.

Q5. Why is the southern part of India called a peninsular plateau?

Answer: The southern part of India has a raised landform with a mostly flat surface. It is bordered by the Western Ghats and the Eastern Ghats and is surrounded by the Arabian Sea, the Bay of Bengal and the Indian Ocean on three sides. Therefore, it is called the Peninsular Plateau.

Q6. Which UNESCO Heritage Site mentioned in the chapter did you find most interesting? Why?

Answer: I find the Great Himalayan National Park in Himachal Pradesh very interesting. It is home to many plants and animals, including rare wildlife. It protects biodiversity and shows the importance of conserving nature.

Note: This is a sample personal-response answer. You may choose another site mentioned in the chapter.

Q7. Identify your present location on the physical and political maps of India. Which physical feature describes its location?

Answer: I am in Siwan, Bihar. On the political map, Siwan is located in Bihar. On the physical map, it is in the northern plains of India, within the broad Indo-Gangetic Plain region.

Q8. Food preservation methods differ across India. Describe some methods.

Answer: People use different methods to preserve food according to local conditions. Some common methods are:

1. Drying: Vegetables, fruits and fish are dried in the sun to remove moisture.
2. Pickling: Fruits and vegetables are preserved using salt, oil and spices.
3. Salting: Salt is used to preserve foods such as fish.
4. Refrigeration: Food is kept at a low temperature to slow spoilage.
5. Making jams: Sugar helps preserve fruits in jams and jellies.

These methods help people store food for later use.

Q9. India has mountains, deserts, plains and coasts. How has geography helped unite the people of India?

Answer: India's geographical diversity has encouraged people to develop different skills, occupations, foods and traditions. Rivers have connected settlements through travel, farming and trade. Coastal areas have supported sea trade, while mountain routes have connected different regions. People share resources, exchange ideas and participate in common cultural and national life. This helps unite India despite its diversity.

Part C: Additional Important Questions and Answers

These questions cover the definitions, facts, comparisons and reasoning-based topics that are useful for revision and examinations.

1. Very short-answer questions

Q1. What is hydroelectricity?

Answer: Hydroelectricity is electricity produced using the energy of flowing or falling water.

Q2. What is altitude?

Answer: Altitude is the height of a place above sea level.

Q3. What is biodiversity?

Answer: Biodiversity means the variety of plants, animals and other living organisms in an area.

Q4. What is flora?

Answer: Flora means the plant life of a region.

Q5. What is fauna?

Answer: Fauna means the animal life of a region.

Q6. What is a tributary?

Answer: A tributary is a river or stream that flows into a larger river.

Q7. What is an alluvial deposit?

Answer: An alluvial deposit is material such as sand, silt and clay deposited by flowing water.

Q8. What is a natural barrier?

Answer: A natural barrier is a physical feature, such as a mountain or desert, that makes movement difficult.

Q9. What is an island?

Answer: An island is a piece of land surrounded by water on all sides.

Q10. What is a mountain range?

Answer: A mountain range is a group or chain of connected mountains.

Q11. What is a delta?

Answer: A delta is a landform formed by sediments deposited at the mouth of a river.

Q12. What is a desert?

Answer: A desert is a region that receives very little rainfall.

2. Give reasons

Q1. The Gangetic Plains are densely populated. Why?

Answer: They have fertile soil, water, agricultural opportunities and good transport facilities.

Q2. The Himalayas are important for India's rivers. Why?

Answer: Snow and glaciers in the Himalayas feed major rivers, especially during warmer months.

Q3. People in Ladakh have adapted to a difficult environment. Why?

Answer: Ladakh has very low rainfall, cold winters and rugged land. People have adapted their way of life to these conditions.

Q4. Water conservation is important in the Thar Desert. Why?

Answer: Rainfall is low and water is scarce, so people must collect and use water carefully.

Q5. The Western Ghats have many waterfalls. Why?

Answer: Rivers flow down their steep slopes, particularly during the monsoon season.

Q6. The Northern Plains have good transport networks. Why?

Answer: Their flat land makes it easier to construct roads and railway lines.

Q7. River deltas are suitable for agriculture. Why?

Answer: Rivers deposit sediments that make delta soils fertile.

Q8. Plateaus are important for the economy. Why?

Answer: They contain minerals, forests and rivers that support mining, industries, farming and electricity generation.

Q9. The Aravalli Hills are geographically important. Why?

Answer: They influence the geography and climate of northwestern India and help limit the eastward expansion of the Thar Desert.

Q10. India has a rich variety of cultures. How is geography related to this?

Answer: Different climates and landforms influence food, clothes, houses, occupations and traditions. This contributes to India's cultural diversity.

3. Compare the following

Q1. Differentiate between the Himadri, Himachal and Shivalik Hills.

Feature	Himadri	Himachal	Shivalik
Other name	Greater Himalayas	Lower Himalayas	Outer Himalayas
Height	Highest	Lower than Himadri	Lowest
Main features	High, rugged, snowy peaks	Moderate climate and settlements	Rolling hills and dense forests

Q2. Differentiate between the Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats.

Western Ghats	Eastern Ghats
Higher mountain range	Lower mountain range
Runs along the western side of the plateau	Runs along the eastern side
Has steep slopes and many waterfalls	Consists of broken, smaller hills
Northern part is also called the Sahyadri Hills	Lies along the eastern coastal region

Q3. Differentiate between the West Coast and the East Coast.

West Coast	East Coast
Lies beside the Arabian Sea	Lies beside the Bay of Bengal
Extends from Gujarat to Kerala	Extends from the Ganga delta to Kanyakumari
Narrower coastal stretches in many places	Has wide coastal plains
Many rivers form estuaries	Major rivers form large deltas
Narmada and Tapti estuaries are important	Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri deltas are important

Q4. Differentiate between a mountain and a plateau.

Mountain	Plateau
A high area of land, usually with steep slopes	A raised area with a more or less flat surface

Often has high peaks and ridges	Often has broad, flat highlands
Example: Himalayas	Example: Deccan Plateau

Q5. Differentiate between an estuary and a delta.

Estuary	Delta
A river mouth where river water mixes with seawater	A landform made by sediments deposited at a river mouth
Often has a broad tidal inlet	Often has a triangular or fan-shaped area
Narmada and Tapti are examples mentioned in the chapter	Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri and Mahanadi form deltas

4. Important questions about rivers and landforms

Q1. How do rivers influence human life?

Answer: Rivers provide water for drinking, farming and industries. They support transport, trade, electricity generation and settlements.

Q2. How do mountains influence climate and human activities?

Answer: Mountains influence rainfall and temperature. They provide water through snow and glaciers, support forests and wildlife, and attract tourists and pilgrims.

Q3. Why are plains suitable for agriculture?

Answer: Plains usually have level land, fertile soil and water sources. These conditions make farming easier.

Q4. How do geographical features influence occupations?

Answer: People in plains often practise farming, while people in coastal areas may depend on fishing and trade. Mountain regions support tourism, animal rearing and other activities. Deserts require careful water management.

Q5. How do rivers help in the development of civilisation?

Answer: Rivers provide water, fertile soil and transport routes. They help settlements grow and support farming, trade and cultural activities.

Q6. What is the difference between a hot desert and a cold desert?

Answer: A hot desert generally experiences very high temperatures, while a cold desert experiences very low temperatures during winter. The Thar is a hot desert, whereas Ladakh is a cold desert.

Q7. How do geographical features provide economic opportunities?

Answer: Fertile plains support agriculture, plateaus provide minerals and hydroelectric power, coasts support fishing and trade, and mountains attract tourism.

Q8. How does geographical diversity support biodiversity?

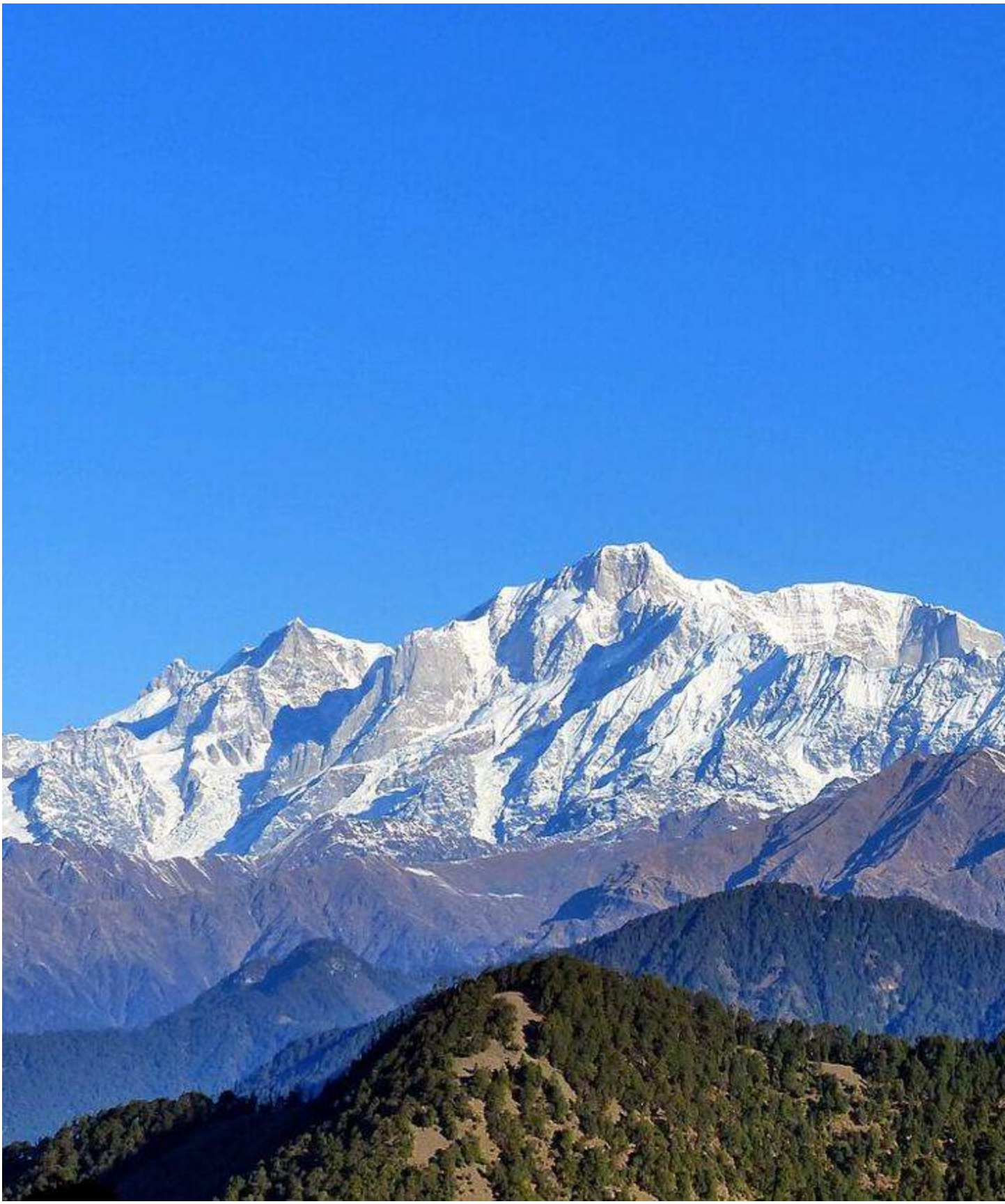
Answer: Different landforms, climates and habitats support different kinds of plants and animals.

5. Important factual questions for revision

Question	Answer
What is the approximate length of the Himalayas mentioned in the chapter?	2,500 km
About when did India collide with Eurasia?	About 50 million years ago
Which river originates at Gaumukh?	Bhagirathi
Which lake in Ladakh has salty water?	Pangong Tso
Which desert is located in western India?	Thar Desert
How old are the Aravalli Hills?	About 2.5 billion years
Name the two mountain ranges bordering the Peninsular Plateau.	Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats
Name three east-flowing rivers of the plateau.	Godavari, Krishna and Mahanadi
Name two west-flowing rivers of the plateau.	Narmada and Tapti
What is the approximate length of India's coastline?	Over 7,500 km
How many islands make up Lakshadweep?	36
Which sea contains Lakshadweep?	Arabian Sea
Which bay contains the Andaman and Nicobar Islands?	Bay of Bengal
Which is the only active volcano in India mentioned in the chapter?	Barren Island
Which famous tiger lives in the Sundarbans?	Royal Bengal Tiger
In which state are the Garo, Khasi and Jaintia Hills located?	Meghalaya
Which village is famous for living root bridges?	Mawlynnong
What does ‘Himalaya’ mean?	Abode of snow

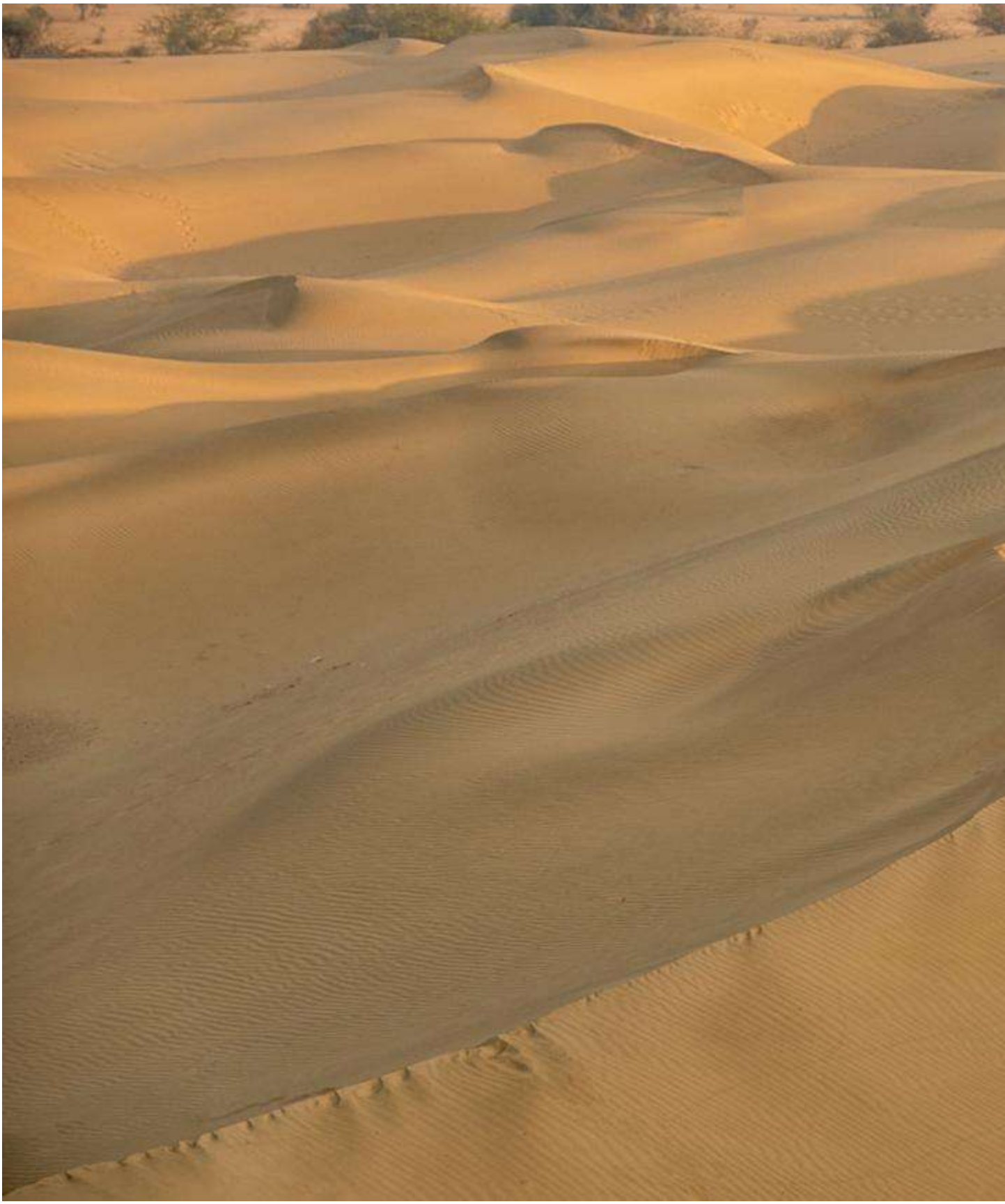
6. Map-based questions

Practise locating these features on the physical and political maps at the end of your textbook.



Northern India

Himalayas, Himadri, Himachal, Shivalik Hills, Gangetic Plains and Ladakh.



Western India

Thar Desert, Aravalli Hills, Gujarat and the western coastline.



Central and Southern India

Peninsular Plateau, Deccan Plateau, Western Ghats, Eastern Ghats, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri, Narmada and Tapti.



Coasts and Islands

Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal, Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Sundarbans and Meghalaya's hills.

7. Important long-answer questions

These questions are useful for preparing answers of about 5–8 sentences.

Q1. Explain how the geographical diversity of India affects people's lives.

Answer: India has many geographical features, including mountains, plains, deserts, plateaus, coasts and islands. These features create different climates and natural conditions. The fertile plains support agriculture and large populations. Mountains provide water and support forests, wildlife and tourism. Deserts require people to conserve water and adapt their lifestyles. Coastal regions support fishing, ports and trade. Thus, geography influences people's food, clothes, houses, occupations and culture.

Q2. Describe the importance of the Himalayas.

Answer: The Himalayas form a major mountain range in northern India. They contain high peaks, glaciers and forests. Snow and ice melt during warmer months and feed rivers such as the Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra. These rivers provide water for drinking, farming and industries. The Himalayas also support wildlife, tourism and religious activities. Therefore, they are important for India's environment, economy and culture.

Q3. Explain the importance of the Peninsular Plateau.

Answer: The Peninsular Plateau is a major raised landform in central and southern India. It lies between the Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats. The region is rich in minerals, forests and other natural resources. Rivers such as the Godavari, Krishna and Mahanadi provide water for farming and industries. Waterfalls help generate hydroelectric power and attract tourists. The plateau is also home to several tribal communities.

Q4. Describe the geographical features of the Thar Desert and how people live there.

Answer: The Thar Desert is located in western India, mainly in Rajasthan. It has sand dunes, dry land, high daytime temperatures and cold nights. Water is scarce because rainfall is low. People have adapted their food habits, clothes and lifestyles to these harsh conditions. Traditional systems such as taankas and kunds help collect and store rainwater. These practices show the importance of conserving water in desert regions.

Q5. Explain the differences between India's major geographical regions and their importance.

Answer: India's major geographical regions include the Himalayas, the Northern Plains, the Thar Desert, the Peninsular Plateau, the coastal plains and the islands. The Himalayas provide water to major rivers. The Northern Plains have fertile soil and support agriculture and large populations. The Thar Desert has a dry climate and requires careful water conservation. The Peninsular Plateau provides minerals, forests and hydroelectric power. The coasts support fishing and trade, while the islands have unique wildlife and strategic importance. Together, these regions contribute to India's economy, environment and culture.

Final revision: The chapter's main message

India's geographical diversity is one of its greatest strengths. Mountains, plains, deserts, plateaus, rivers, coasts and islands provide different resources and opportunities. They shape people's ways of life and have influenced India's history and civilisation. Despite these differences, all these regions form one country with a rich and shared cultural heritage.

Study tip: First learn the definitions and short answers, then practise the nine textbook questions, followed by the comparison tables and long answers. Also revise the maps, because knowing the locations of the major physical features will help you understand the chapter better.